

44 Discussing problems

English uses the third conditional to talk about an unreal past, or events that did not happen. This is useful for talking about workplace mistakes.

 **New language** Third conditional
Aa Vocabulary Workplace mistakes
 **New skill** Talking about past mistakes



44.1 FILL IN THE GAPS BY PUTTING THE VERBS IN THE CORRECT FORMS TO MAKE THIRD CONDITIONAL SENTENCES

If you had worked (work) late, you would have finished (finish) the presentation.

- 1 We _____ (sign) the contract if the deadline _____ (not be) so tight.
- 2 If we _____ (leave) earlier, we _____ (not miss) the train.
- 3 If the waitress _____ (not be) so rude, we _____ (not complain).
- 4 If we _____ (order) before 3pm, we _____ (receive) the goods today.
- 5 We _____ (not lose) the client if we _____ (deliver) the report on time.
- 6 If you _____ (repair) the printer, we _____ (not cancel) the contract.
- 7 If I _____ (know) how expensive it was, I _____ (put) it in the safe.
- 8 The boss _____ (not shout) if you _____ (admit) your mistake.
- 9 If you _____ (be) more prepared, you _____ (give) a better presentation.
- 10 We _____ (give) you free delivery if you _____ (pay) on time.
- 11 If I _____ (know) our competitor's price, I _____ (offer) a bigger discount.
- 12 We _____ (meet) our deadline if we _____ (employ) more staff.
- 13 If you _____ (not be) off sick, we _____ (invite) you to the meeting.
- 14 We _____ (pay) the full amount due if you _____ (not miss) our deadline.
- 15 If you _____ (sell) more products last time, we _____ (ask) you to lead the pitch.

